

Instructor: Date:

Learner: Regional Branch:

Program: Center:

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Let's Start!

The future is here!



Learning Outcome

Exchange information about unlikely events or fairly certain conditions that will be fulfilled in present, past or future in spoken or written texts and in work and social contexts.

Can Do Statements

- I can talk about technology and gadgets.
- I can introduce conditions under which something is true.
- I can talk about two actions together.

Ask your partner:

- What new highly innovative gadgets have you heard or read about?
- How many modern gadgets do you own, and what are they?

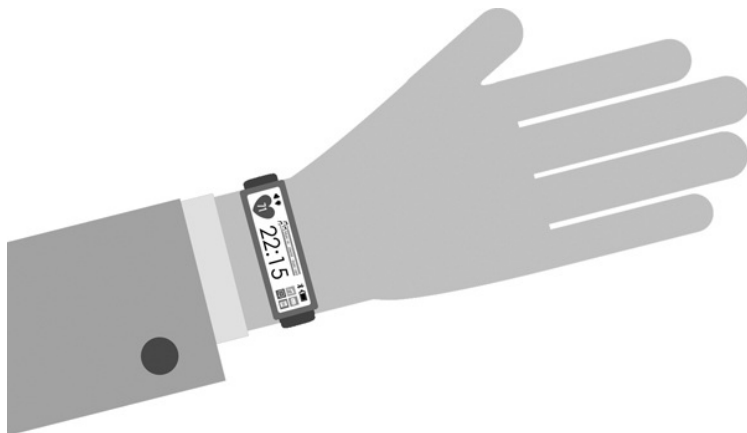




Let's Explore!

Powering* your smartphone with a thermoelectric generator!

* You can use the word "power" as a verb as well as a noun.



Instructions: Read the text aloud.

If you want to keep powering your smartphone, pick up one of the new thermoelectric generators. If this technology works, you can power your cellphone someday soon by using your body heat. Forget using a clumsy charger, the thermoelectric generator can actually convert heat into energy - electrical energy! Imagine wearing this small generator as a wristband. It produces power (about 40 milliwatts of it) by using the slight difference in temperature between your skin and the air surrounding it when you have it on. Soon, you will be able to start charging devices that don't take too much energy, like cellphones, with one.

Remember watching people use those handheld medical scanners on Star Trek? If it is to be believed, they are a step closer to reality thanks to a new breakthrough in technology. Scientists have developed a way to use the technology behind full-body security scanners. The waves from these are also capable of detecting biological changes, like an increase in the flow of blood around a tumor. The researchers report finding they can be used to make better compact medical scanning gadgets. If this happens smaller, cheaper, easier to use devices are on their way!

If the new round of universal translators is any indication, they are not ready to use yet. Try using a device that is not word perfect. Start up a casual conversation by insulting someone. Not exactly what you wanted to do? Well, if you employ the machine at this time, that is precisely what it ends up doing. Most of the tests have gone roughly as well as this. If you want a machine to recognize voices, it is much harder to make one than originally thought, it seems.

Some innovations are coming, some faster than others. Scientists never think about giving up. They are always interested in moving forward.





Let's Practice!

These are some expressions you hear and use when talking about technology.

Instructions: Read the clues. Find the words in the word search below.

1. to provide something with the energy it needs to operate (P _ _ E _)
2. a machine which produces electricity (G _ _ _ R _ _ _)
3. use something (_ M _ _ O _)
4. to change the character, appearance, or operation of something (_ O _ V _ _ T)
5. all around a particular place or thing (S _ _ _ O U _ _ _ _ G)
6. a machine which reads information and puts it into a computer system (S _ A _ _ _ R)
7. a sign that something exists, is true, or likely to happen (_ N _ I _ _ T _ _ _)

Q	X	S	V	T	A	L	W	X	C	T	T	Z	A	R	S	V	Q
F	B	G	S	C	J	W	B	H	E	V	N	Z	E	I	D	F	R
P	R	R	E	Q	T	B	D	L	S	E	R	G	M	C	Q	P	D
P	I	O	N	N	N	O	Z	B	W	P	V	J	O	S	H	K	P
O	G	D	L	E	E	O	B	R	E	M	E	S	A	R	B	I	W
A	A	F	I	I	M	R	H	W	C	J	G	P	S	G	V	G	N
D	D	R	P	J	T	N	A	K	Z	E	M	P	L	O	Y	H	Z
F	E	A	A	O	V	V	Q	T	W	H	Y	V	D	Z	H	C	T
A	I	N	D	I	C	A	T	I	O	N	L	P	E	X	W	N	U
I	R	G	Q	F	S	S	Z	X	A	R	S	G	P	A	W	R	V
W	O	O	U	Y	D	L	V	C	O	M	I	D	A	V	Q	C	S
C	O	N	V	E	R	T	S	V	P	P	X	U	F	U	B	I	C
I	R	I	C	Z	B	J	X	D	A	T	J	K	M	I	Y	N	A
I	H	E	A	C	K	T	L	J	U	O	Z	B	J	A	I	U	N
D	S	R	S	M	Q	S	J	J	G	T	W	T	E	D	M	D	N
G	Q	C	B	T	F	Y	C	Y	K	N	O	T	V	S	M	O	E
G	N	I	D	N	U	O	R	R	U	S	U	A	C	H	Z	O	R
V	S	A	X	Q	E	A	R	E	W	O	P	O	O	C	P	F	V



Let's Practice!

You can talk about two actions that are linked together. Let's see!

Instructions: Read the dialogue again. Match the two halves to correctly complete each sentence. Practice saying the sentences aloud. Check your pronunciation with your instructor.

- | | |
|--|---|
| 1. If this technology works, you can one day power your smartphone | a. convert heat, or a temperature difference, into electric energy! |
| 2. Forget using a clumsy charger, the thermoelectric generator can | b. in moving forward. |
| 3. Imagine using the generator | c. as a wearable wristband device. |
| 4. The researchers' report found the technology can be used | d. to make better compact medical scanning gadgets. |
| 5. They are always interested | e. by using just body heat. |





Extension Activity

Find out about technology influenced by Star Trek.

Instructions: Complete the following steps. Fill in the Self-Assessment.

- In the 1960s Star Trek was an innovative new futuristic series, where many new technological items were used.
- Do some reading (or listening) to find out how many of these technologies have actually come to be.
- Write a brief summary of 5 items, tying it to what we use or will soon be using.
- Read your summaries to a partner or group and discuss them.

Self-Assessment

Yes

No

I read about or listen to descriptions of items now or soon in use previewed on Star Trek.

☐ ☐

I write a brief summary of 5 items.

☐ ☐

I use the real conditional.

☐ ☐

I tie the items to what is now or will soon be in use.

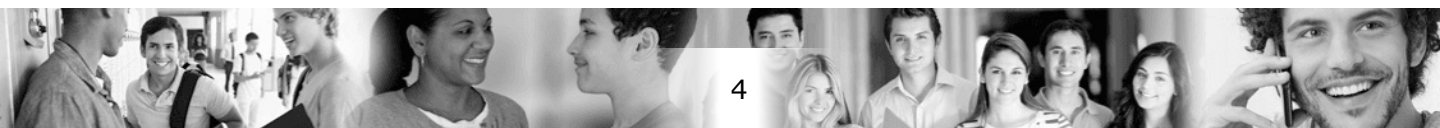
☐ ☐

I share my summaries and discuss them.

☐ ☐


Target Words

- to power** (verb): to provide something with the energy it needs to operate
e.g. If this technology works you can one day power your smartphone by using just body heat.
- generator** (noun): a machine which produces electricity
e.g. If you want to keep powering your smartphone, pick up one of the new thermoelectric generators.
- to employ** (verb): to use
e.g. If you employ the machine at this time, that is exactly what it ends up doing.
- to convert** (verb): to change the character, appearance, or operation of something
e.g. The thermoelectric generator can actually convert heat into energy - electrical energy!
- surrounding** (adjective): all around a particular place or thing
e.g. It produces power by using the slight difference in temperature between your skin and the air surrounding it.
- scanner** (noun): a machine which reads information and puts it into a computer system
e.g. Remember watching people use those handheld medical scanners on Star Trek?
- indication** (noun): a sign that something exists, is true, or likely to happen
e.g. If the new round of universal translators are any indication, they aren't ready to use yet.





Learning Points

The Real Conditional: Expressing Truth Conditions

You use the Present Real Conditional to talk about true conditions in the present or in the future.

You use both *if* and *when* in the Present Real Conditional. When you want to talk about true conditions, *If* and *When* have the same meaning.

Example:

If you want to keep powering your smartphone, pick up a glass and fabric-based thermoelectric generator.

Notice the structure of this type of conditional:

If / When ... Simple Present ..., ... Simple Present ...

Look at the examples from the text:

Examples:

- *If it is to be believed, they are a step closer to reality thanks to a new breakthrough in technology.*
- *If this happens smaller, cheaper, easier to use devices are on their way!*
- *If the new round of universal translators are any indication, they are ready to use yet.*
- *If you want a machine to recognize voices, it is much harder than originally thought, it seems.*





Learning Points

Verbs Followed by -ing

When you talk about two actions linked together, you normally use two verbs. The first verb follows the rules of conjugation for the sentence, while the second verb can be a verb in the -ing form.

You can use two verbs to talk about two connected actions. The main verb introduces the main action, and the second verb in the -ing form gives more information about that action.

You can use a variety of verbs followed by a verb in the -ing form. Some of these verbs are related in meaning, or have opposite meanings, like:

like/dislike, start/stop, can't bear/stand, love/adore/hate, allow/forbid, admit/deny, quit/finish, appreciate/resent ...

Other verbs followed by verbs in -ing are prepositional verbs like *end up, carry on, keep on, go on, ...*

Structure:

Subject + first verb + -ing form of the second verb.

Look at some examples from the text:

Examples:

- *The researchers report finding this technology can be used to make better compact medical scanning gadgets.*
- *Try using a device that is not word perfect. Start a conversation by insulting the person you are speaking to.*
- *If you employ the machine at this time, that is exactly what it ends up doing.*
- *So innovations are coming, some faster than others. Scientists never think about giving up. They are always interested in moving forward.*

